



Jieun Lee

PhD in Economics from University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Visiting Scholar, Department of Economics at Emory University

Research Interest: Econometrics, Machine-Learning

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Language: English (fluent), Korean (native)

Citizenship/Immigration: South Korea (citizen), United States (permanent resident)

Academic Position

Emory University, USA

Visiting Scholar, Department of Economics, 2025 – Present

Research collaboration with Esfandiar Maasoumi; Teaching courses in economics.

Postdoctoral Fellow, Rollins School of Public Health, 2023 – 2025

Served as Econometrician, leading causal machine learning and quantitative projects.

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC), USA

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in *Economics* (2023) *Dissertation: Essays on Spatial, Health, and Socioeconomic Interactions*

Master of Science (MS) in *Mathematics* (2022); *Statistics-Applied* (2021)

Ewha Womans University, South Korea

Master of Arts (MA) in *Economics* (2016); Bachelor of Arts (BA) in *Economics* (2013)

Research Interest

Econometrics, Machine-Learning

Research

Econometrics, Machine-Learning

Publication

1. Testing the Endogeneity of a Spatial Weight Matrix in the Weak-Tied Spatial Dynamic Panel Data Model (sole-authored). *Econometric Reviews*, (2025), 44(4), 462–511. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07474938.2024.2427600> [Publication](#)
[Manuscript](#) [Package](#)

Working Papers

3. Informativeness under Model Uncertainty: Shadow Prices and Ridge Penalties (with Esfandiar Maasoumi). *Under Review*. [Manuscript](#) [\[arXiv\]](#)
2. Risk-Optimal Curvature Selection for Finite-Sample Cressie–Read Moment Estimation (with Anil Bera). *Under Review*. [Manuscript](#) [\[arXiv\]](#)
1. Network Multipliers in Gravity Models (with Hanbat Jeong). [Manuscript](#) [\[arXiv\]](#)

Work in progress

6. Machine Learning for Policy Implication (with Sue Mialon).
5. Endogenous Network Formation under Congestions (with Florian Gunsilius).
4. General Shrinkage Estimation (with Esfandiar Maasoumi).
3. Knowledge Spillover and Growth Miracles (with Stephen L. Parente).
2. Knowledge Heterogeneity in Growth Miracles (with Jiheum Yeon).
1. Robust Standard Error Adjustment (with Hanbat Jeong).

Empirical Studies: Economics/Interdisciplinary

2. Identifying Novel Social Determinants of Health Subgroups among the General US Population: A Machine Learning Approach (with Xue, Q., Li, P., Mitchell, E., Weber, M.B., Yue, D., Hong, Y., Dieci, M., Harding, J.L., Ali, M.K., Shao, H.) *Submitted*.
1. Investment in Social Capital by the Korean Elderly and Baby-Boomers (with Vladimir Hlasny). *The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, (2020), 17, 100256. [Publication](#) [Manuscript](#)

Seminar & Conference (*: Scheduled)

2026: American Economic Association; UIUC; Georgia Tech; Georgia Econometrics Workshop; Korea Development Institute; Econometric Society (North American Summer Meeting); Emory (Guest lecture in ECON 540)*; Southern Economic Association*

2025: American Diabetes Association Scientific Sessions; Econometric Society World Congress; KSU/Emory Global Diabetes Research Center Symposium; Midwest Econometrics Group; UIUC; Emory; Southern Economic Association

2024: American Diabetes Association Scientific Sessions; Midwest Econometrics Group

2023: Purdue (Ag Econ); Rutgers; UIUC (Guest lecture in ECON 575; Econometrics lab lunch seminar); Midwest Econometrics Group; Spatial Econometrics Association; Computational and Financial Econometrics

2022: Midwest Econometrics Group (Mentoring Workshop for Junior Female Economists)

2019: MEEA

2016: East Asian Social Policy Network; Korea and the World Economy; Aging & Society

Professional Service & Membership

Referee for *Spatial Economic Analysis* (x2), *Journal of Organizational Effectiveness: People and Performance* (x2), *PharmacoEconomics*, *Journal of Diabetes Research*.

Member of the *Econometric Society*, *American Economic Association (AEA)*, *Korea-America Economic Association (KAEA)*, *Korean Women Economists Networking (KWEN)*, *Spatial Econometrics Association (SEA)*, *Southern Economic Association (SEA)*.

Teaching/Grading Experience**Macroeconomics & Machine Learning (ECON 422)**

2026 (Fall) Instructor, Department of Economics, Emory University

Econometric Analysis I (PhD Core, ECON 532)

2020 (Fall) & 2021 (Fall) & 2022 (Fall) Grader, Department of Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Econometrics of Policy Evaluation (Undergraduate, ECON 474)

2022 (Spring) Grader, Department of Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Macroeconomic Principles (Undergraduate, ECON 103)

2019 (Spring) & 2020 (Spring) Discussion Section Instructor and Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Statistics in Economics (Undergraduate, ECON 202)

2017 (Fall) & 2018 (Spring, Fall) Discussion Section Instructor and Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2014 (Fall) & 2015 (Spring) Discussion Section Instructor and Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Ewha Womans University

Microeconometrics (Graduate)

2015 (Spring) Discussion Section Instructor and Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Ewha Womans University

Applied Econometrics (Undergraduate)

2014 (Spring) & 2015 (Spring) Discussion Section Instructor and Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Ewha Womans University

Honors, Scholarships, and Awards

Scholarship

Department of Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, USA

Scholarship for Conference (2017 Fall, 2018 Fall)

Fellowship for PhD Students (2016 Fall, 2017 Spring)

Korea Student Aid Foundation, South Korea

Graduate Research Scholarship for Humanities and Social Sciences (2014)

Awards

Paper Competition for the Market Economy, South Korea (2014)

How to Lower the Barrier to Entry for Women in Korean Labor Market by Game Theory

Bestowed by KB Financial Group Inc. Chairman; organized by Market Economic Research Institute

Economic Universiade, South Korea (2012)

A Far-Sighted Policies to Develop Human Resources for the Economic Growth in Korea

Bestowed and organized by Edaily, Korea Association of Economic Education, SK communications; Sponsored by the Ministry of Strategy and Finance, Ministry of Knowledge Economy, Ministry of Education, Science and Technology, Ministry of Employment and Labor, Ministry of Environment